

## Project Planning Phase

### Project Planning (Product Backlog, Sprint Planning, Stories, Story Points)

|               |                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Date          | 27 June 2026                                                                                                                                            |
| Name          | Giritharan D                                                                                                                                            |
| Project Name  | An employee or students submits an innovation idea through the Innovation Hub, where it is reviewed by a reviewer and approved or rejected by a manager |
| Maximum Marks | 5 Marks                                                                                                                                                 |

#### 1. Product Backlog, Sprint Schedule, and Estimation

The product backlog defines the major features of the InnovateHub: Innovation Idea Portal and organizes them into planned sprint activities. Each task is estimated based on its complexity to ensure systematic development, testing, and successful implementation of the application.

| Sprint   | Feature (Epic)      | User Story ID | User Story / Task                                                                  | Story Points |
|----------|---------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Sprint-1 | Idea Submission     | USN-1         | As an employee, I can submit a new innovation idea with all required details.      | 3            |
| Sprint-1 | Reviewer Process    | USN-2         | As a reviewer, I can review ideas, add comments, and update the review status.     | 3            |
| Sprint-1 | Manager Approval    | USN-3         | As a manager, I can approve or reject reviewed ideas and give approval comments.   | 2            |
| Sprint-2 | Status Tracking     | USN-4         | As an employee, I can view the current status of my submitted idea at any time.    | 2            |
| Sprint-2 | Notifications       | USN-5         | As a user, I receive notifications when my idea is reviewed or approved.           | 2            |
| Sprint-2 | Reports & Dashboard | USN-6         | As an administrator, I can view reports and dashboards to monitor submitted ideas. | 3            |

#### 2. Burndown Chart & Progress Metrics

A burndown chart tracks the remaining work (measured in Story Points) throughout each sprint and helps monitor project progress. For the InnovateHub: Innovation Idea Portal project, it was used to measure development progress, identify pending tasks, and ensure timely completion of the application features.

##### Sprint-1 Burndown Analysis

##### Starting Baseline: 8 Story Points

- **Mid-Sprint Status (Day 5):** Successfully completed USN-1 (3 Story Points) by creating the Innovation Idea table, designing the submission form, and configuring the required fields. USN-2 (3 Story Points) was completed by implementing role-based access for the Reviewer and securing records using ACLs and Client Scripts. The sprint remained on schedule with all core functionalities working as expected.
- **Sprint Closure:** Successfully completed USN-3 (2 Story Points) by implementing the Manager Approval process, final status updates, and role-based field permissions.

All Sprint-1 tasks were completed successfully with no pending Story Points.

## **Sprint-2 Burndown Analysis**

### **Starting Baseline: 7 Story Points**

- **Mid-Sprint Status (Day 5):** Successfully completed USN-4 (2 Story Points) by implementing idea status tracking and notification updates. USN-5 (2 Story Points) was completed by configuring reports and dashboards to monitor submitted, reviewed, approved, and rejected ideas.
- **Sprint Closure:** Successfully completed USN-6 (3 Story Points) by performing functional testing, fixing minor issues, validating user roles, and completing project documentation. All Sprint-2 activities were completed successfully, and the InnovateHub application was fully functional with zero pending Story Points.

### **3. Individual Sprint Retrospective**

A personal sprint retrospective was conducted after completing both development sprints to evaluate the progress of the **InnovateHub: Innovation Idea Portal** project, identify areas for improvement, and enhance future ServiceNow application development.

#### **What Went Well**

- **Efficient ServiceNow Development:** The low-code features of ServiceNow made it easy to create tables, forms, roles, ACLs, client scripts, and approval workflows with minimal coding effort.
- **Clear User Role Management:** Implementing separate roles for **User**, **Reviewer**, and **Manager** improved security and ensured that each user could access only the relevant sections of the application.
- **Automated Idea Workflow:** The application successfully automated the innovation idea lifecycle, including idea submission, review, manager approval, and status tracking, reducing manual work and improving transparency.

#### **What Could Be Improved**

- **Role-Based Field Validation:** Configuring field-level access for different user roles required additional testing to ensure that only the appropriate sections were editable for each role.
- **Workflow and Testing Time:** More time was needed to test client scripts, ACLs, UI policies, and approval workflows to verify that all business rules worked correctly under different user roles.

#### **Action Items for the Next Phase**

1. **Enhance Workflow Automation:** Integrate email notifications and automatic reviewer assignment to further streamline the innovation approval process.
2. **Improve Analytics:** Develop advanced reports and interactive dashboards to monitor idea submissions, review progress, approval rates, and overall innovation performance in real time.